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Corporate Sustainability Culture in Oil and Gas Industry – Enablers and Challenges

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Abstract

The paper shares learnings from building a corporate sustainability culture as an infrastructure for environmental and sustainability programs by identifying enablers and challenges common to the oil and gas organisations, which are relatively advanced in their sustainability journey. The study presents conclusions from a survey carried out within oil and gas industry and presents learnings in the context of the theoretical exploration of the subject of organisational sustainability culture in recent literature.

A closer look at the successes and challenges in developing sustainability and environmental culture within the petroleum industry so far, leads to identification of three main success factors: (1) Strong corporate commitment, visible in practice and genuinely committed leadership; (2) Translating corporate sustainability approach into economic value (such as business development advantage, technological innovation agility, energy savings, cost reduction); (3) Communication of targets and progress towards them and cascading sustainability objectives down to organisational units. The study identifies several prevailing challenges, including: (1) Lack of resources; (2) Lack of leadership or visibility of it and (3) skepticism around either the positive role of oil and gas in climate action or the authenticity of corporate sustainability efforts.

When comparing survey respondents' experience of the organisational sustainability culture to its theoretical models, it can be concluded that (a) sampled organizations' programs are most developed in the areas suggesting external drivers, such as legislative and customer requirements or public opinion pressure, (b) sustainability vision, corporate values and their communication are seen as the most culture enabling elements of the theoretical model in practice, and (c) challenges in building a sustainability culture are present in all main elements of the theoretical model, likely indicating that the industry is still gaining the experience and developing its approach and solutions for sustainability.

Conclusions and implications can be utilized by organisations in early stages of designing sustainability and environmental stewardship programs to consider maximizing the identified success factors while mitigating the challenges to build a sustainability culture that enables organisations to respond to environmental and social demands and build organisational resilience.

Introduction

One cannot imagine a petroleum industry where health and safety would not be considered at the forefront of all business activities, where every employee would not consider health and safety assurance a part of their job. This has been achieved by building an industry-wide organisational health and safety culture through education, communication, shared values, standards and systems and through employee and leadership's engagement in safety. It has, however, taken several decades to get to this maturity level and there is still room for improvement.

Organisational culture of the past, which focused primarily on profit, has changed with the development of health and safety culture, but it still requires a considerable transformation to effectively respond to social and environmental issues (Howard-Grenville, 2006).

With environmental stewardship, the industry cannot afford the time spent gradually shaping the culture because of the imminent requirement for sustainable business practices as part of national and international commitments to climate action and sustainable development, including industry's participation in energy transition.

Corporate sustainability can be enabled or hindered by attributes of organisational culture (Ketprapakorn, Kantabutra, 2022), therefore, it is important to recognize and consider those attributes for designing effective sustainability programs.

Method

Theoretical models of organisational sustainability culture and its main elements based on the General Systems Theory by L. Von Bertalanffy, as presented in (Ketprapakorn, Kantabutra, 2022) in combination with the learnings from development and maturation of sustainability culture within the oil and gas industry so far, were used in this study to design a sampling survey aimed at gauging the industry stakeholders' opinion on which aspects have helped building sustainability culture in the organisations they relate to, and what have been the main challenges and obstacles in the process.

The survey entitled "Building a Sustainability Culture within Offshore Energy Industry Organisations" was distributed in December 2022 and May 2024 to:

- Management of member companies of the Offshore Energies UK Environmental Forum¹ gathering the industry's operators and contractors from the UK continental shelf,
- Management representatives of five largest Norwegian continental shelf operators,
- Management representatives of several Middle East operators and supplier companies.

The survey participation request included a statement that it is looking for opinions and reflections on the sustainability program implementation and sustainability culture, and the responses are not meant to represent official company's stance on any of the subjects covered.

All sections included a space for responder's comments.

All respondents were offered an opportunity to elaborate on their expressed opinions by participating in an informal interview as a follow-up to completing the questionnaire.

The survey was designed to ensure anonymity, although an option for the responders to provide their identification details was also provided.

Definitions

Organisational sustainability culture

A recent comprehensive literature review on the theory of organisational sustainability culture points out a wide variety of definitions existing in the literature, most of which include shared assumptions, values,

and beliefs about sustainability or a balance between social, environmental and economic outputs that drive the organisational processes and practices. Drawing from those definitions, the study proposes to define sustainability culture as "an organisational culture, with underlying shared assumptions, values and beliefs about solving sustainability problems, that shapes the organisational behaviors through corporate decision making and practices of the organisation" (Ketprapakorn, Kantabutra, 2022).

For the purpose of the surveys used in this paper, sustainability culture is defined as an organisational culture where sustainability concept is integrated into organisational mission and vision and strategy, where sustainability approach is applied to everyday business decisions and activities, and reflected in shared assumptions and values, leadership commitment, employee engagement and community stewardship.

Organisational sustainability program

For the purpose of the survey, sustainability program was defined as a formal documented framework for processes and controls related to:

- Accounting for and reduction of the organization's GHG emissions,
- Environmental competence assurance,
- Environmental awareness and communication,
- Employee engagement,
- Environmental risk management,
- Policies and procedures describing environmental controls,
- Legal compliance assurance.

Environmental, social, governance aspect of sustainability

The definition of sustainability, in relation to culture and programs in this study, is limited to environmental aspects rather than social and governance ones, except where those are tightly interlinked, i.e., survey questions on environmental legislation compliance naturally included an element of governance and community engagement questions included element of social aspect of sustainability.

Findings

Survey participation

22 companies participated in the survey in December 2022, and 23 in May 2024.

64% of respondents chose to complete the survey anonymously. The remaining 36% of respondents provided their name and job role and the name of the organisation they work for. All of the survey participants hold senior managerial or/and senior technical positions in their respective organisations.

All respondents, including those who decided to complete the survey anonymously, were asked to disclose the type of organisation they work in, and therefore relate their responses to, so that the survey scope and results can be better understood.

68% of the respondents declared working for oil and gas operators, 18% for small-medium supplier organisations, and 14% for large suppliers 2.

Survey design

Survey questions were designed to reflect the elements of the integrated theory of sustainability culture and its model (Ketprapakorn, Kantabutra, 2022) and the Competing Values Framework model as described in (Linnenluecke, Griffiths, 2010), so that the survey conclusions can serve as an indication of the level to which the theoretical elements of the models are present in the organisations sampled.

Authors of the survey were also interested to observe which elements of the theoretical models are assigned with greatest significance to the development of the culture based on the respondents' empirical knowledge.

The below table summarizes the main elements of the integrated theory model and lists the survey questions corresponding with the theoretical elements.

Table 1—relation between survey questions content and elements of theoretical models of the sustainability culture.

Integrated theory model	Question number ³	Question focus
External environment	Q3, Q4, Q5, Q18, Q24, Q29, Q32	Legal and other requirements compliance, consumer/client pressures, access to capital, local community engagement, public opinion
Input – Human resources	Q7, Q19, Q20, Q26, Q28	Competence, expertise, training, roles and responsibilities
Sustainability assumptions	Q29, Q33, Q34	Environmental protection, perceived authenticity of sustainability programs, assumptions on organisational responsibility
Sustainability vision and corporate values	Q1, Q2, Q11, Q12, Q14	Expressions of corporate and leadership commitment
Communication	Q10, Q12, Q13, Q17, Q21, Q25, Q27, Q28	Communication of targets, objectives and responsibilities; engagement initiatives, awareness
Shared values and believes	Q14, Q17, Q25, Q29, Q33, Q34, Q35	Perceived leadership commitment, employee engagement, attitudes and believes
Emotionally committed members	Q8, Q15, Q16, Q17, Q29, Q33	Engagement, environmental protection, attitudes and believes
Sustainability practices and processes	Q6, Q9, Q11, Q23, Q28, Q35	Management systems, incl. policies, procedures, practices, training
Output and feedback	Q18	Local community engagement

Survey findings

Section 1) Sustainability programs implementation status. Survey questions on the sustainability programs development and implementation status were aimed at gauging the organisational productivity in the area of sustainability, so that a potential correlation between organisation's sustainability programs' maturity and participants' views on the sustainability culture can be identified. It was also aimed at identifying any shortcomings of the sustainability programs that may affect successful development of the sustainability culture.

Refer to [Appendix A](#) for details of Section 1) questions, scoring legend and full survey section results.

Analysis of responses resulted with an indication that respondents' sustainability programs were strong in the areas of:

- Environmental risk management (Q3) – 55% indicated fully developed and implemented program (score A) and another 41% indicated good level of development (score B),
- Environmental management system processes (policies, procedures, work instructions) (Q9) – 41% indicated fully developed and implemented programs (score A) and further 36% well developed and implemented programs (score B).
- Emissions monitoring (Q4) – 27% fully developed and implemented programs (score A), and further 59% well developed and implemented programs (score B),
- Emission reduction targets (Q5) – 14% fully developed and implemented programs (score A), and 68% well developed and implemented programs (score B).

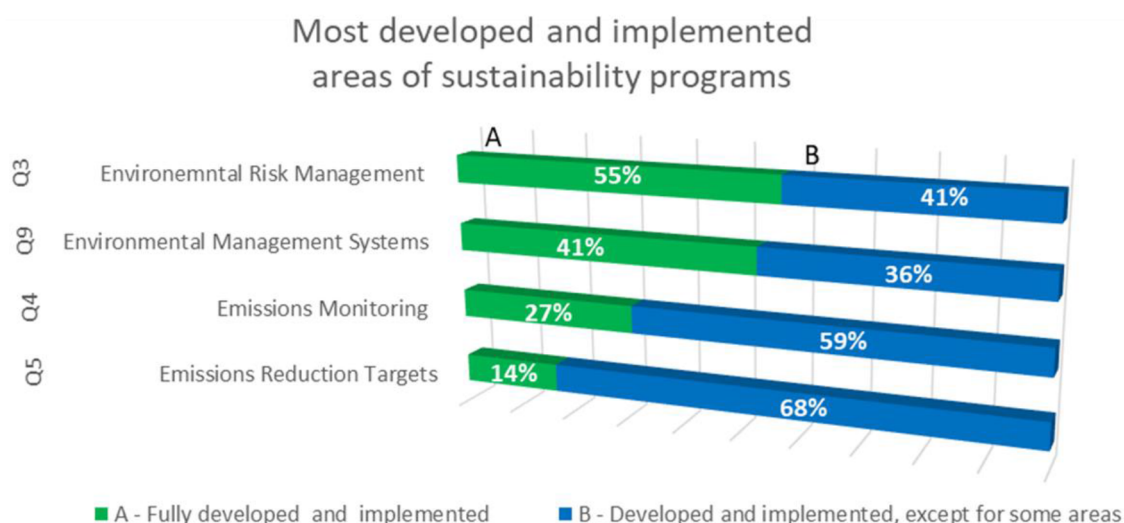


Figure 1—Opinions on most developed and implemented areas of sustainability programs.

The areas where their respective organisations' sustainability programs were the least developed in respondents' opinion were:

- Competence assurance (Q7) – 9% of respondents declared there was no formal process in place, 18% of respondents assigned score D – in planning, with some controls implemented (i.e., those legally required), and further 36% indicated that those elements are in development or partially implemented (score C),
- Identification and assignment of roles and responsibilities (Q6) was in the planning stage in the opinion of 14% of respondents (score D), with a further 23% indicating roles and responsibilities were in development or partially implemented (score C).
- Sustainability objectives (Q2) – 9% of the respondents considered objectives to be in the planning stage (score D), while a further 45% indicated they are in development or partially implemented (score C),

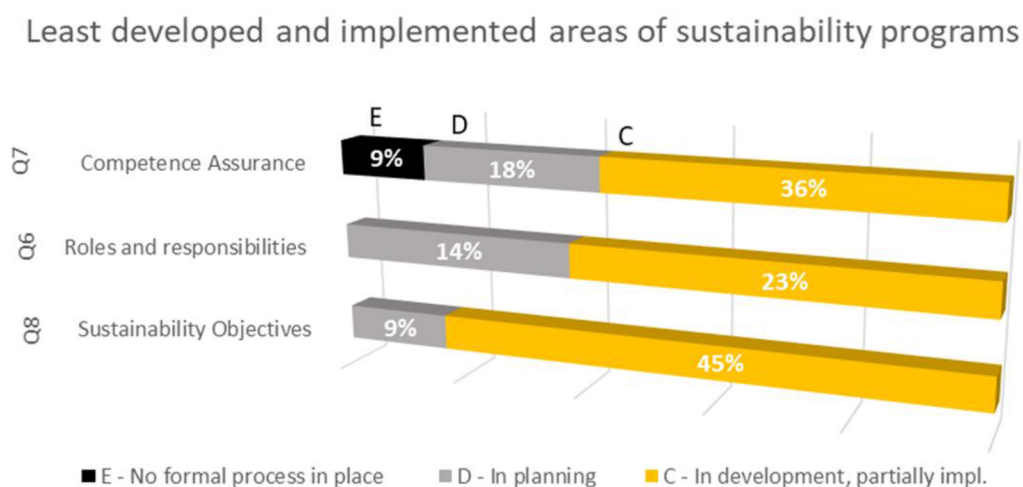


Figure 2—Opinions on least developed and implemented areas of sustainability programs.

50% of respondents scored employee engagement (Q8) with A and B indicating a very good level of development and implementation, and another 50% with scores C, D and E, indicating a lower level of implementation, planning or no formal process existing.

4.5% of respondents indicated no formal process existing (score E) for emissions monitoring (Q4), emissions reduction targets (Q5), roles and responsibilities (Q6) and employee engagement accordingly.

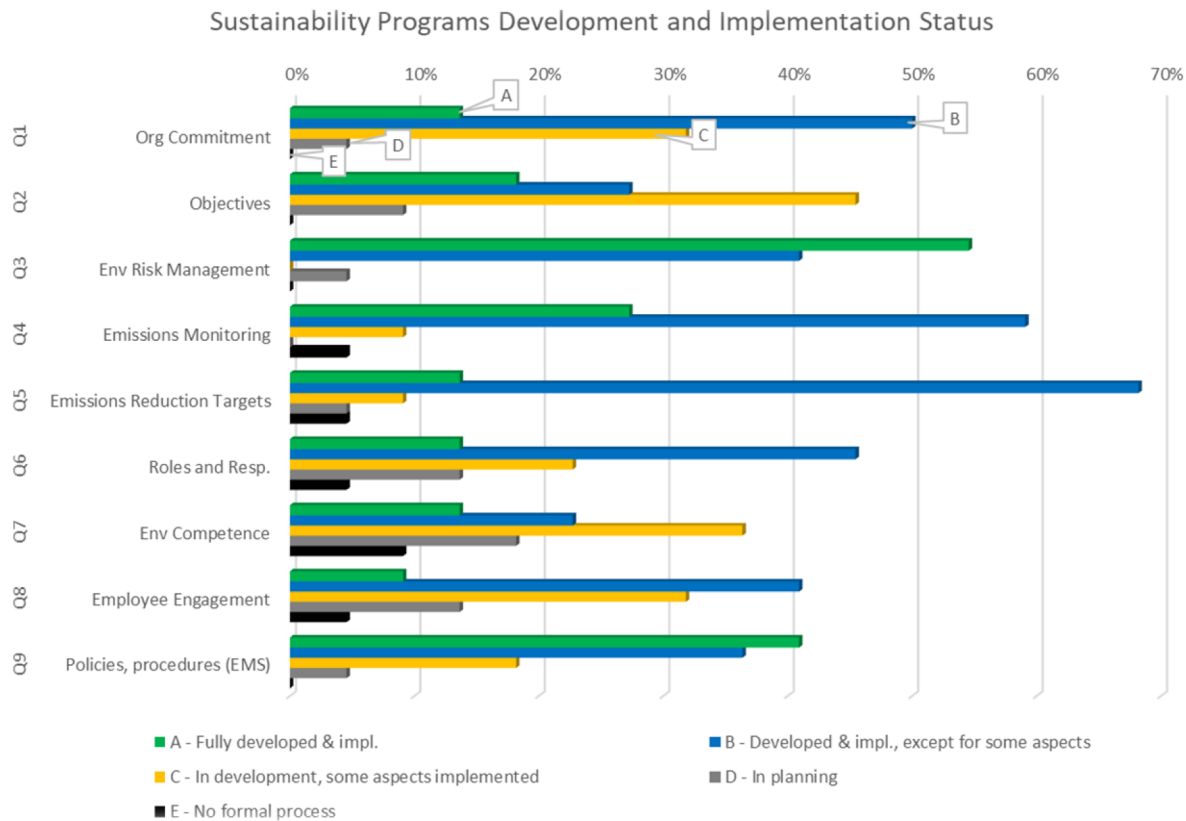


Figure 3—Opinions on organisational sustainability programs implementation status

Section 2) Sustainability culture enablers. Survey questions in section 2 proposed several actions and approaches that can have a positive impact on developing an organisational sustainability culture. Respondents were asked to grade the potential culture enablers from most significant to those that were not considered contributing to development of sustainability culture.

Refer to [Appendix A](#) for details of Section 2) questions, scoring legend and full survey section results.

In respondents' opinion the most significant sustainability culture enablers are:

- Visible corporate commitment (in practice) (Q11) – 57% of respondents scored it with A (most significant enabler) and a further 38% thought it was a significant enabler (score B),
- Genuine, strong and visible commitment from the leadership (Q14) – 48% of respondents identified it as the most important enabler (score A), with a further 38% agreeing it's a significant one (score B),
- Translating sustainability efforts into economic value (understood as business development advantage, technological innovation agility, energy savings, cost reduction, and other) (Q12) was identified as the most significant culture enabler (score A) by 43% of respondents, with a further 43% considering it a significant enabler (score B),
- Communication of targets and progress towards them (Q10) was considered the most significant enabler (score A) by 24% of respondents with a further 67% identifying it as a significant enabler (score B).

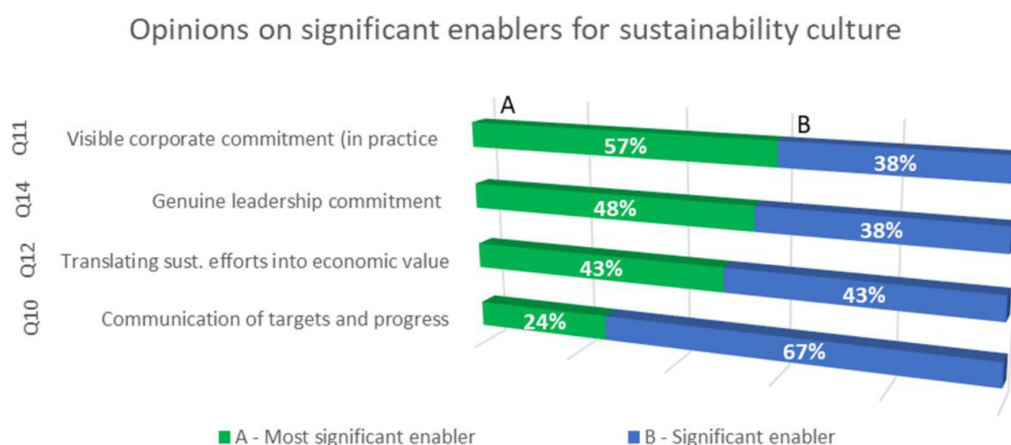


Figure 4—Opinions on significant enablers for sustainability culture

Furthermore:

- Sustainability objectives cascaded down to the departmental level (Q13) were recognized as the most significant enabler (score A) by 24% of the respondents, with a further 24% considering them a significant enabler (score B).

When asked to select the top 3 enablers from the list (Q10 – Q21) the respondents confirmed the choices presented earlier in this section and selected the following 3 enablers:

- Visible corporate commitment (in practice) (Q11) – 76% of respondents,
- Genuine, strong, visible commitment from the leadership (Q14) – 43%,
- Translating sustainability into economic value (Q12) – 38%,
- Sustainability objectives cascaded down to departmental levels (Q13) – 33%.

Because the visibility of corporate commitment and genuineness of leadership commitment are close in meaning, they have been grouped into one enabler and the next enabler most often selected as one of the top three is listed as the additional one, as illustrated in Fig.5:

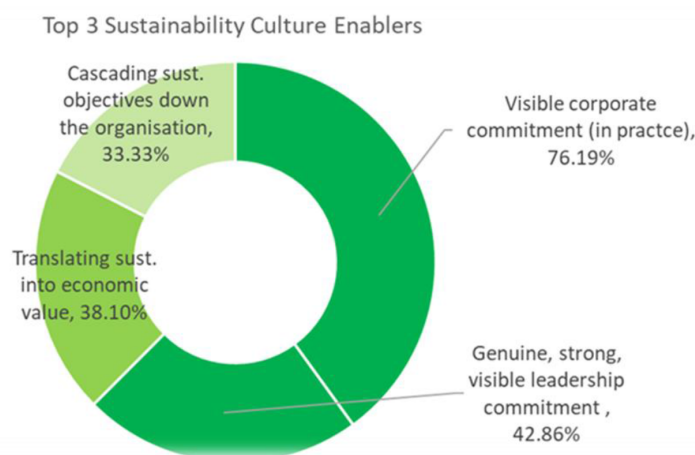


Figure 5—Top 3 sustainability culture enables as selected from a list of potential enablers.

The following aspects listed as potential enablers in Q10 – Q21 were considered not to be contributing to the sustainability culture:

- Incentivizing employees (Q16) assigned score D – Not a contributor by 14% of respondents, and
- Supporting local community (Q18) by another 14%.

Section 3) Sustainability culture challenges. This section of the survey listed potential challenges to building a sustainability culture. Respondents were asked to grade the suggestions from most significant challenges to those that were not considered a challenge to sustainability culture development.

Refer to [Appendix A](#) for details of Section 3) questions, scoring legend and full survey section results.

Analysis of responses resulted with an indication that in respondents' view the most significant difficulties in building a sustainability culture in oil and gas organisation are:

- Lack of resources (Q26) selected as most significant challenge (score A) by 38% of respondents, with a further 33% considering it a significant challenge (score B),
- Lack of leadership commitment or visibility of it (Q25) identified as most significant challenge (score A) by 24% with a further 38% identifying it as a significant challenge (score B),
- Skepticism towards either the role that oil and gas can play in climate action, or towards the genuineness of corporate sustainability efforts (Q29) was identified as the most significant challenge (score A) by 14% of respondents, while a further 29% considered it a significant challenge (score B),

Although clearly recognised as either the most significant or a significant challenge in comparison with other aspects of culture, it was also recognised as "difficulty, but not a challenge" (score C) by 38% of respondents and as "not a challenge" (score D) by a further 19%.

- It is worth noting that the variety of methods and standards for sustainability stewardship and emissions accounting (Q24) were identified as the most significant challenge (score A) by 10% of the respondents and as a significant challenge (score B) by a further 43%,
- Underdeveloped or insufficient sustainability programs (Q23) are considered the most significant challenge (score A) for only 5% of the respondents, however, as much as 57% identified it as a significant challenge to building a sustainability culture (score A).

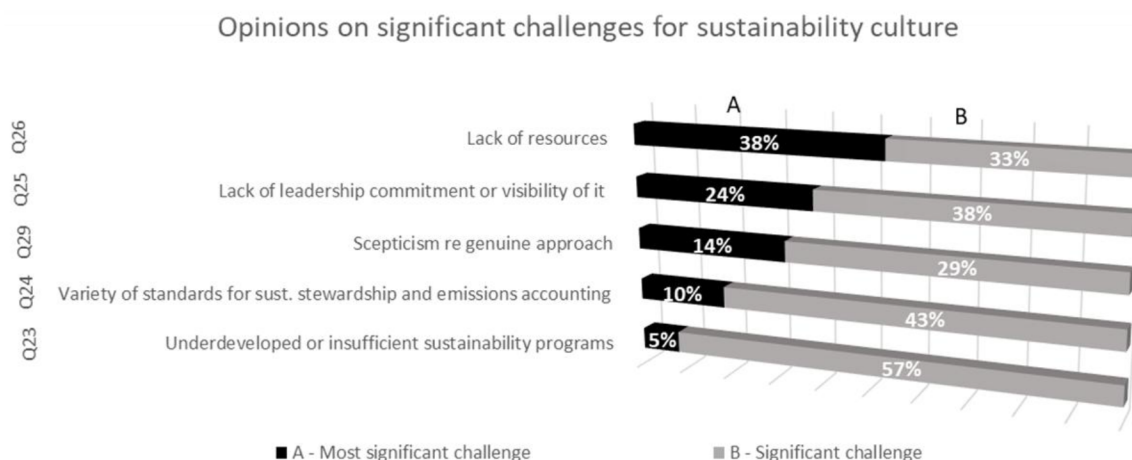


Figure 6—Opinions on significant challenges for sustainability culture

The survey participants were asked which of the listed challenges they consider to be the top three to building a sustainability culture in an oil and gas organisation, the following aspects were identified, as illustrated in Fig. 7.

- Lack of leadership commitment (Q25) – 62%,
- Lack of resources (Q26) – 57%,
- Lack of awareness and training (Q28) – 47%.

Top 3 Sustainability culture challenges

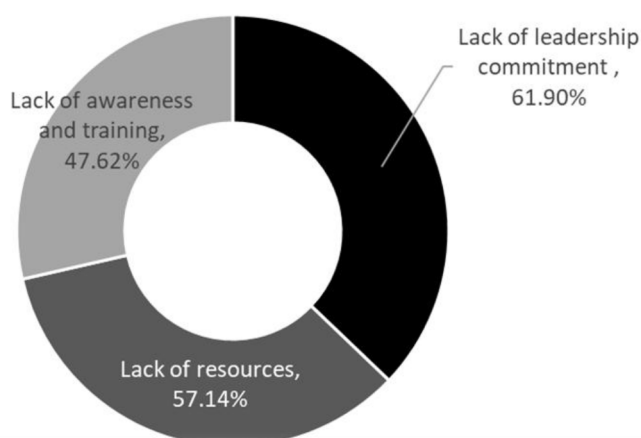


Figure 7—Top 3 sustainability culture challenges as selected from a list of potential challenges.

Lack of awareness and training (Q28) was not seen as the most significant challenge (score A – 10%). 38% of respondents considered it a significant challenge, but 43% didn't think it was significant (score C), and 10% listed it as not a challenge (score D).

However, when respondents were asked to select top 3 challenges out of the list of Q23 – Q29, lack of awareness and training was selected as such by 48% of respondents.

Respondents were given an opportunity to comment on any other challenges they can identify and 4 of the respondents have expressed additional views. Refer to [Appendix A](#), Section 3) to view respondents' additional comments.

Section 4) Sustainability in the industry. The final section of the survey enquired about observed attitudes and beliefs of the oil and gas industry stakeholders regarding sustainability, and especially regarding the genuineness of the drivers behind corporate sustainability programs. Authors were keen to establish if the respondents felt there was skepticism towards declared sustainability program goals amongst the industry stakeholders, and if they felt there was a tendency to "green wash" in the industry, and whether it could hinder development and maturation of organisational sustainability culture.

Refer to [Appendix A](#) for details of Section 4) questions, scoring legend and full survey section results.

Analysis of responses indicated the respondents' tended to agree most with the following statements as illustrated in Fig. 8:

- Majority of people in my organisation genuinely care about protecting the environment (Q33) – 43% strongly agreed (score A) and 52% agreed,
- People find it easy to engage in sustainability processes if they are part of wider management system and when sustainability is normalized by inclusion in operating procedures and risk management (Q35) – 38.10% strongly agreed and further 38.10% agreed,

- It seems that people in my organisation perceive sustainability responsibilities as additional to their core duties, and therefore of secondary importance (Q34) – 29% strongly agreed (score A) and 48% agreed,
- 67% of the respondents agreed with the statement that there is a tendency for skepticism in the industry (Q32) (38% strongly agreed and 29% agreed), however, another 33% disagreed with that statement.

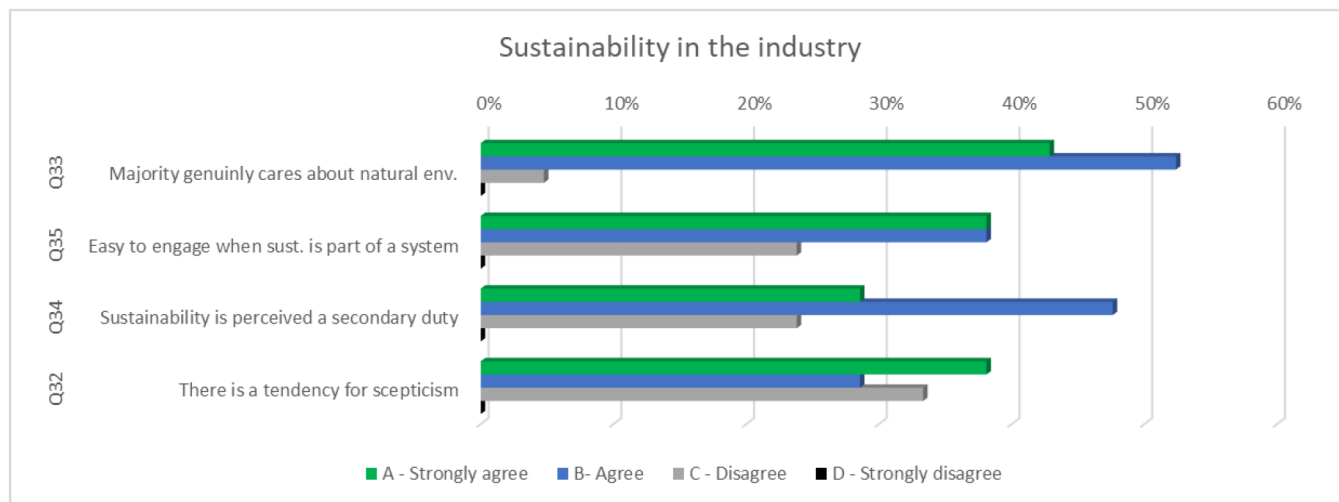


Figure 8—Sustainability in the industry statements of opinion

Relation to theoretical models

Analysis of responses to survey questions plotted on Table 1 content indicate that:

- In section 1 of the survey, respondents indicated that the most developed and implemented areas of their sustainability programs (Q3, Q4, Q5 and Q9 marked with an asterisk in Table 2) were related to external environment elements of the sustainability culture model, which includes those elements outside of the system that affects all parts of the system, i.e., legal regulations, other external requirements and commitments, consumer and client pressure, access to capital and investment, public opinion, and other. Internal process means, as described in Competing Values Framework model (Linnenluecke, Griffiths, 2010), such as training and development, communication, objectives and engagement are considerably less developed. This could be an indication of early stages of programs and culture development and adaptation, where priority is given to compliance and governance, and meeting consumer and customer demands.
- The most significant sustainability culture enablers as selected by the respondents, based on their organisational sustainability culture experience (Q10 – Q14 highlighted in Table 2), were grouped around 2 elements of the integrated theory model – Sustainability vision and corporate values and communication of them. This could be an indication that the importance of visibly committed leadership communicating and practicing the vision and values should not be underappreciated as a practical managerial implication for improving sustainability culture.
- The most significant sustainability culture challenges identified by the respondents in section 3 of the survey (Q23 – Q26 and Q29 underlined in Table 2) are found in all of the main elements of the theoretical culture model. It can be concluded that the industry has not yet gained relevant experience necessary for successful implementation of the sustainability programs and culture and is still developing its approach and solutions.

Table 2—Relation between survey responses and elements of theoretical models of the sustainability culture.

Integrated theory model	Question number ⁴	Question focus
External environment	Q3*, Q4*, Q5*, Q9*, Q18, Q24, Q29, Q32	Legal and other requirements compliance, consumer/client pressures, access to capital, local community engagement, public opinion
Input – Human resources	Q7, Q19, Q20, Q26, Q28	Competence, expertise, training, roles and responsibilities
Sustainability assumptions	Q29, Q33, Q34	Environmental protection, perceived authenticity of sustainability programs, assumptions on organisational responsibility
Sustainability vision and corporate values	Q1, Q2, Q11, Q12, Q14, Q25	Expressions of corporate and leadership commitment
Communication	Q10, Q12, Q13, Q17, Q21, Q25, Q27, Q28	Communication of targets, objectives and responsibilities; engagement initiatives, awareness
Shared values and believes	Q14, Q17, Q25, Q29, Q33, Q34, Q35	Perceived leadership commitment, employee engagement, attitudes and believes
Emotionally committed members	Q8, Q15, Q16, Q17, Q25, Q29, Q33	Engagement, environmental protection, attitudes and believes
Sustainability practices and processes	Q6, Q9, Q11, Q23, Q28, Q35	Management systems, incl. policies, procedures, practices, training
Output and feedback	Q18	Local community engagement

Interviews

7 respondents agreed to be informally interviewed to elaborate on the viewed expressed in the survey questionnaire. It was possible to arrange 3 interviews. All interviewees work in large organisations with mature sustainability programs.

The areas highlighted by the interviews as concerning in development of the environmental stewardship programs and sustainability culture can be summarised as:

- Training and competence – including carbon auditing competence and consistency of standards for certification,
- Lack of consistency in selection and application of scope 3 emissions accounting guidelines within the offshore energy industry. All interviewed survey participants called for, or mentioned, a need for industry collaboration in the matter,
- Insufficient internal organisational communication on sustainability and environment. Some respondents indicated that the complex sustainability terminology and concepts, as well as reasons behind sustainability projects are not sufficiently explained to organisational stakeholders,
- Decision making processes (i.e., for selecting environmentally friendly solutions during product or service life cycle) are not established or not clear enough,
- The level of skepticism or sufficient trust in the effectiveness of current sustainability efforts within the industry seem to vary depending on geographical location and opposing views are present within the organisations that the interviewees work for.

Conclusions and Indications

The study's objective was to gather views and opinions on the most common enablers and challenges in the development and maturation of sustainability culture within oil and gas industry organisations.

As a result of analysis of responses to the survey and interviews conveyed amongst sampled oil and gas organisations, and consideration given to the theoretical context of the sustainability culture, the study conclusions can be summarised as follows:

Although sustainability programs are developed and implemented to a varied degree in all sampled organisations, a common trend can be observed for the elements like environmental risk management, environmental management systems and emissions monitoring and reduction to be prioritised and matured more than elements like competence assurance, assignment of roles and responsibilities, or employee engagement.

Considered in the context of theoretical models of sustainability culture (Ketprapakorn, Kantabutra, 2022, Linnenluecke, Griffiths, 2010), sustainability program areas that are most developed are those externally oriented and related to the environment the organisation functions in, indicating that the industry is prioritising compliance and governance and critical external parties' demands and expectations over internal cohesion and controls, which could be the next element of the organisational sustainability culture model for the corporate leaders to focus on.

Strong and visible corporate commitment, leadership and communication of targets, progress and objectives were seen as the most significant sustainability culture enablers in respondents' opinion and experience, along with translating corporate sustainable approaches into economic value, including business development advantage, technological innovation agility, energy savings, cost reduction, and other, which in essence is a form of communication of the sustainability vision and objectives too. Such a degree of unanimity of opinion of the industry stakeholders whose sustainability programs are relatively advanced can be a valuable implication for other organisations that are in the process of building a sustainability culture.

The importance of committed and visible leadership is stressed further by the fact it was also listed as one of the most significant sustainability culture challenges by the survey participants, along with lack of resources and scepticism around either the role that the industry can play in climate action or the authenticity of the drivers behind corporate sustainability efforts.

The problem of potential scepticism was offered as one of sustainability culture challenges in an attempt to gauge its extent in the oil and gas industry in respondents' opinion because sustainability assumptions, shared values and beliefs and emotional commitment of organisational members are important elements of the culture which could be hindered by wide spread scepticism towards the purpose of the industry environmental sustainability efforts or authenticity of corporate efforts in that respect. Although clearly recognised as a significant challenge in comparison with other aspects of culture, it was also recognised as "difficulty, but not a challenge" by 38% of respondents and as "not a challenge" by a further 19%. It can be concluded that although it exists, it does not currently pose a considerable concern to industry stakeholders participating in the survey. A possible implication of this learning could be to proactively prevent the negative impact of this aspect on the organisational culture through communication of sustainability vision for the industry, for example its role in the energy transition.

The challenges also identified as significant included the variety of standards and guidelines available for environmental stewardship and emissions accounting, which was further emphasised in the interviews with survey participants.

The challenges identified are distributed relatively evenly across the various elements of the theoretical model of the sustainability culture, likely indicating that the industry is still developing its approach and solutions for sustainability and there is a scope for improvement in all of the areas rather than a specific element of the culture.

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Appendix 1

Survey summary

Building a Sustainability Culture within Offshore Energy Industry Organisations

Survey section 1 - Sustainability Programs Implementation Status

Respondents were asked to assign scoring to selected areas of sustainability programs listed below to indicate their perceived stage of development and implementation.

Areas (questions):

- Q1. Organisation and its leadership's commitment to sustainability
- Q2. Sustainability objectives
- Q3. Environmental risk management
- Q4. Emissions monitoring
- Q5. Emissions reduction targets
- Q6. Identification and assignment of roles and responsibilities
- Q7. Environmental and sustainability competence assurance
- Q8. Employee engagement (initiatives, programs)
- Q9. Policies, procedures, work instructions (Environmental Management System)

Scoring:

- A. Fully developed and implemented, communicated, utilized, and considered part of everyday activities across all levels of the organisation. Compliance assessed and monitored. Continual improvement evident.
- B. Developed and implemented, but some aspects require completion or improvement
- C. In stage of development, partially implemented with various degree of compliance, depending on the aspect
- D. In planning stage, with some environmental controls implemented as part of legal or ISO14001 compliance
- E. No formal process exists. Some controls are implemented as part of legal compliance.

Survey section 2 - Sustainability Culture Enablers

Respondents were asked to choose factors that contribute most to building a sustainability culture in their organisations, by assigning the following scoring:

- A. Most significant enabler
- B. Significant enabler
- C. Contributor, but not significant
- D. Not a contributor

The factors listed:

Q10. Communication of sustainability targets and objectives, communication of progress monitoring results

Q11. Visible corporate commitment (including infrastructure and system changes, optimization of product and service life cycle, reducing waste, promotion of eco-friendly solutions, community engagement, etc.)

Q12. Translating sustainable approach into economic value (business development advantage, technological innovation agility, energy savings, cost reduction, etc.)

- Q13. Sustainability objectives cascaded down to departmental objectives
- Q14. Genuine, strong and visible commitment from the leadership
- Q15. (Sustainability/environmental) working groups / projects engaging all levels of employees
- Q16. Incentivizing employees
- Q17. Employee engagement initiatives and company-wide events, including inspiring employees' interest in sustainability and environmental protection and enabling discussion
- Q18. Local community engagement and support initiatives and events
- Q19. Competence assurance
- Q20. Skilled professionals assigned to manage sustainability programs
- Q21. Including sustainability and environmental responsibilities in all job descriptions, in employee performance KPIs and appraisals

Survey section 3 - Sustainability Culture Challenges

Respondents were asked to choose factors that present the greatest challenge in building a sustainability culture in their organisations, by assigning the following scoring:

- A. Most significant challenge
- B. Significant challenge
- C. Difficulty, but not significant
- D. Not a challenge

The factors listed:

- Q23. Underdeveloped or inefficient sustainability program (framework of processes and objectives)
- Q24. Variety of methods and standards for sustainability stewardship and emission accounting
- Q25. Lack of leadership commitment or visibility of it
- Q26. Lack of resources
- Q27. Insufficient or inadequate internal communication
- Q28. Lack of awareness and training
- Q29. Judgement / cognitive bias – i.e., skepticism related to the potential for insincere drivers behind corporate environmental and sustainability programs, or to "green washing"

Respondents were given an opportunity to comment on any other challenges they can identify and 4 of the respondents have expressed additional views by stating:

- "Too many meaningless targets will work against sustainable future"
- "Sale of business has put commitment on hold for the roll of the many sustainability culture"
- "Collaboration, time, industry reinvention, commercial incentives (carbon mechanism, etc.)"
- "Cost"

Survey section 4 - Sustainability in the industry

The survey participants were asked to agree or disagree with the following statements regarding the opinions on sustainability within the oil and gas industry, by selecting:

- A. Strongly agree
- B. Agree
- C. Disagree
- D. Strongly disagree

Statements:

Q32. There seems to be a tendency for skepticism around the role oil and gas organisations can play in climate action or related to the potential for insincere drivers behind corporate environmental and sustainability programs, or to "green washing".

Q33. Most people in my organisation seem to genuinely care about protecting natural environment.

Q34. It seems that people in my organisation perceive sustainability responsibilities as additional to their core duties, and therefore of secondary importance.

Q35. People find it easy to engage in sustainability processes if they are part of a wider management system and when sustainability is normalized by inclusion in operating procedures and risk management.